

COURSE · MODULE 05

Module 05 · Governance and risk

Who builds, who verifies, who decides and who can accept a risk

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20 minutes	3 safeguards that are never reduced	25 cells in the risk matrix	4 risk levels
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01

Objective

By the end you will be able to explain the framework's segregation of duties, assign the roles of an initiative without incompatibilities and read a risk register: inherent level, residual level and the body that can accept it.

02

Key ideas

1. **Nobody approves themselves.** Whoever builds neither verifies nor decides their own work; risk clearance is independent of the team; the board approves the direction and the risk appetite.
2. **There is no need to create new bodies.** In a medium-sized company, the management committee with a monthly AI item, a one-person AI Office and an independent auditor for Enterprise initiatives are enough.
3. **Risk = probability × impact**, from 1 to 25, in four levels. It is assessed before controls (inherent) and after them (residual).
4. **Each level has its accepting body.** A Critical residual risk can only be accepted by the board; without that approval, it blocks G3 and G5.

Guided tour

Step	What to open	What to look at
1	document 01, section 8	Initiative roles, incompatibilities and company bodies.
2	document 30, section 11	The adaptation to small organisations.
3	document 33, sections 4 to 7	Scales, inherent and residual risk, responses and acceptance.
4	document 32, section 5	The regulatory classification tree: it is done before design.
5	T06 (risk view of the register)	The 5 × 5 matrix of the example portfolio and the observations it generates.

Exercise

In the risk view of the example register, click the cell with the highest residual risk. Which initiative is it, who has accepted it and does it have a contingency plan? Then switch to inherent risk and see how much the controls reduce the risk: is that reduction credible?

Self-check

1. Can the sponsor also be the risk owner of their own initiative?
2. Who accepts a High residual risk?
3. By which phase must the risk register already exist?
4. What happens to a Lite initiative that starts processing specially protected data?

Next step

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Answers. 1) No: they are incompatible roles. 2) The AI Committee. 3) Phase 3; it is a G3 criterion. 4) It moves to Enterprise intensity: intensity is reviewed at G3 and at each R6, and one criterion is enough.